

CBD OIL

Info Pack

Medicinal cannabis for
chronic pain management

Everything you need to know about your
prescription, your dosing, and the team
supporting you.



Contents

FOUR SECTIONS

-
- | | | |
|----|---|-----|
| 01 | Understanding medicinal cannabis | 3–4 |
| | What it is, how it can treat chronic pain, what to expect once prescribed, and how your prescription reaches you. | |
-
- | | | |
|----|--|-----|
| 02 | Your journey with PCA | 5–6 |
| | Our process, the experts you can access, what to do now, and how long your medication takes to arrive. | |
-
- | | | |
|----|---|------|
| 03 | Dosing guidelines | 7–12 |
| | Dosage FAQs, questions about your medication, side effects, storage, travel, driving and drug interactions. | |
-
- | | | |
|----|---|-------|
| 04 | Your care team & how to administer | 13–16 |
| | Psychology, physiotherapy and nutrition support, what to expect in your parcel, and step-by-step dosing instructions. | |
-

Questions at any point?

Speak to your designated case manager — we are with you every step of the way.

1300 070 910

info@painclinicaustralia.com.au



What is medicinal cannabis?

Legal, prescription-grade and quality-assured cannabis preparations intended for human therapeutic use.

This includes pharmaceutical preparations such as oils, tinctures, capsules and other extracts. Each one contains specific active components in known amounts and mixtures, which can be carefully controlled, standardised and administered for patient use.

100+

Cannabinoids identified in the cannabis plant so far.

500+

Active compounds known within the plant.

The active ingredients are a diverse group of chemical compounds called **cannabinoids**. They work by reacting with your body's natural cannabinoid receptors.

No two patients are the same

Several products are available in Australia with various compositions, so treatment needs to be tailored to the individual. Your doctor is the best person to determine what is right for you, based on your medical condition, current medications and past treatments.



How medicinal cannabis can treat chronic pain

We help you understand whether medicinal cannabis treatment is right for you, with expert advice from our Australian-registered health practitioners and our team of patient coordinators.

What to expect once prescribed

- 1 Medication delivered directly to your door.
- 2 Continuous support from your designated case manager.
- 3 Frequent access to your psychologist, physiotherapist and nutritionist.
- 4 Access to useful online video content.

How do I receive my prescription?

Once prescribed, your medication is dispensed from a licensed pharmacy and delivered to your nominated address. We use the Australia Post premium eParcel service, and you'll receive regular SMS updates during delivery.

DISCLAIMER

This guide does not contain all available information on medicinal cannabis. All medicines have risks and benefits. Cannabis is a drug and it can have negative side effects or interactions with other medications or supplements. This guide is not a substitute for consulting your treating doctor or case manager. If you have any doubts or queries, please contact your treating doctor.

Welcome to your pain management program

This pack guides you through the steps required to reduce your chronic pain and optimise your treatment.

OUR PROCESS

01

Doctor's consult

02

Quick delivery

03

Case management

04

Ongoing review

ACCESS TO INDUSTRY EXPERTS AND RESOURCES

Psychology

CBT therapy and techniques for mental well-being.

Physiotherapy

Functional assessments and exercise programs.

Nutrition

Clinical dietitian and nutritionist guidance to reduce inflammation.

Online resources

The Liberate video series, available from day one.



After your doctor's consultation

What do I need to do now?

You are one step closer to beginning your chronic pain management journey with PCA. All you need to do now is wait for your medication to arrive.

What happens next?

Your medication has been prescribed and sent to our licensed pharmacist for compounding. Within the next few days it will be on its way to your door via discreet delivery.

During this time you'll be given access to our **Liberate** video series. You can also book in with our clinical dietitian and nutritionist for nutritional guidance, our physiotherapist for functional assessments and exercise programs, and our psychologist for mental well-being and CBT therapy.

5–7

Business days for your medication to arrive, depending on national holidays.

How will I know it's on its way?

Your medication is dispensed from a licensed pharmacy and sent via Australia Post premium eParcel. You'll receive regular SMS updates during delivery.

Your case manager is your single point of contact throughout. If anything is unclear, call **1300 070 910** before changing anything about your treatment.

Taking medicinal cannabis safely

There is no one-size-fits-all approach to treating chronic pain, which is why dosages differ from one patient to the next. Together, we aim to achieve three things for you.

The most pain relief

- 01 Meaningful, measurable improvement in your day-to-day function.

At the lowest dose

- 02 We start low and adjust slowly, guided by your response.

With minimal side effects

- 03 Reported early, managed quickly, reviewed with your doctor.

The following pages cover the questions patients most often ask when commencing treatment.



Dosage FAQs

How should I administer my medication?

Refer to the specific dosing instructions given by your treating doctor. These cover all the details related to the medication you have been prescribed.

How should I take my medication?

As directed by your doctor. Ingested medication such as oils provides maximum benefit when swallowed or taken with food.

Do my doses have to be taken at the same time each day?

It is recommended that you administer your intake at the same time each day, so that your progress can be measured accurately.

Can I take doses more frequently throughout the day?

Some patients require more frequent doses to increase relief through the day. For ingested forms such as oils, most patients find one dose provides approximately six to ten hours of relief.

Doses must always be at least six hours apart, unless your treating doctor instructs otherwise.

Can I take doses less frequently?

Always follow your medical certificate. For further questions about dosing, speak with your doctor or case manager for advice.

MAXIMUM DOSAGE

In general, the maximum dosage is one millilitre per day. Your medical certificate always takes precedence.

1ml/day

Questions about my medication

Is my medication working?

You will know your medication is working when you start sensing some relief from your symptoms.

When can I expect to feel the effects?

For ingested forms, expect to feel an effect within 30 to 60 minutes after each dose. These effects generally last six to ten hours. With consistent use over several weeks, you may experience an increase in these effects.

30–60 min

Until you feel the effect of an ingested dose.

6–10 hrs

Typical duration of relief per dose.

I think I need a higher dose — can I increase it?

You may require a higher dose if you do not feel any relief from your symptoms or notice any benefit. Speak to your doctor or case manager for advice before changing anything.

I think my dose is too high — can I decrease it?

You may require a reduced dosage. For further questions in relation to your dosage, please speak to your doctor or case manager for advice.

Never adjust your dose on your own. One call is all it takes to check.

1300 070 910

Side effects and how we manage them

Medicinal cannabis is typically well tolerated. A small percentage of patients may experience one of these known side effects.

- Dizziness

- Fatigue or lethargy

- Anxiety

- Dry mouth

- Diarrhoea or gastrointestinal upset

When side effects tend to occur

Within the first two weeks of starting treatment, if your dose is increased, or if there has been a change to other pre-existing medications.

Managing side effects

Most side effects greatly reduce within the initial two to four weeks of use. If you are experiencing any of them, inform your doctor or case manager for further advice.

If you experience negative effects, contact your doctor or call the poisons hotline.

13 11 26

Storage and travel

How do I correctly store my medication?

Refer to the instructions on your medicine. In general, medication should be stored upright in a cool, dry, dark place at less than 25°C, out of the reach of children. We do not recommend refrigerating your medication — it can become thick and difficult to draw up.

Can I travel with my medication in Australia?

Yes. Within Australia you are permitted to carry a three month supply of medicinal cannabis, carried in its original box or container.

- You must also carry a valid prescription or a letter from your doctor with the specifics of your medication.

IMPORTANT

Do not take your medication out of Australia

You are strongly advised not to exit Australia with your medication. PCA has explicitly cautioned that you could be apprehended by customs officers and face severe penalties, including imprisonment, depending on the countries you travel to or through and their local laws.

If you are planning travel, speak to your case manager first on **1300 070 910** so your supply and documentation can be arranged in advance.



Driving and other medications

DO NOT DRIVE ON THC

If your medication contains THC, do not drive or operate machinery

PCA has explicitly advised you against driving or operating machinery while THC remains in your system.

How long does THC stay in your system?

24 hrs

Clearance for some patients.

3–4 days

The usual clearance window.

Up to 21 days

For certain individuals it can take two to three weeks.

Because clearance varies so widely, it is strongly recommended that you buy a THC testing kit — from your local pharmacy or online — and test yourself regularly to understand how quickly you clear THC from your system.

Can I take medicinal cannabis with other medications?

Before you are prescribed medicinal cannabis, you will advise your doctor of your full medical history, including all other drugs and medications your GP has prescribed. Your doctor reviews your current medication to reduce the risk of negative side effects when you commence treatment.



Managing chronic pain with PCA

Chronic pain management involves both your physical pain and your lifestyle. Alongside medicinal cannabis, try adjusting your diet and incorporating mindfulness exercises to boost your pain relief.

PSYCHOLOGY

Do I need to see the PCA psychologist?

Our in-house psychologist supports and guides you through your pain journey. You'll learn techniques to better understand your pain, reduce your pain experience, improve social function, and manage the stressors in your life that can cause increased inflammation.

PHYSIOTHERAPY

Should I see the PCA physiotherapist?

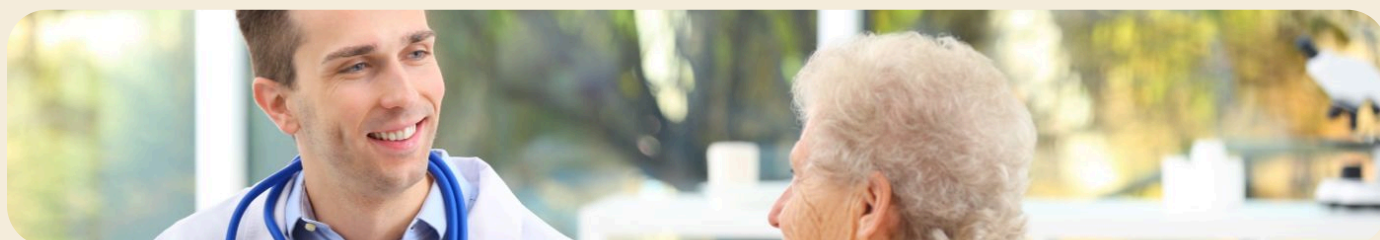
Chronic pain can be extremely painful, physically. Our physiotherapist helps you manage that pain with hands-on support, functional assessment and education on what you can do day to day.

NUTRITION

Why do I need to see the PCA nutritionist?

The food you consume can affect the level of your chronic pain. Our in-house nutritionist provides diet and nutrition guidance to help reduce inflammation.

Bookings for all three services are arranged through your case manager on **1300 070 910**.



Your parcel has arrived

If this is your first time using medicinal cannabis, check your email for your Medical Certificate. Always follow the dosage set out in that certificate.

What should I expect to see in my parcel?

01

Your bottle(s) of medication

02

One syringe per bottle

03

One stopper (adapter) per bottle

FIRST USE — INSTRUCTIONS

- 1 Twist the lid anti-clockwise to unscrew and open the bottle.
- 2 Carefully peel back the white seal over the opening of the bottle. It can now be discarded.
- 3 Place the bottle on a flat, stable surface. Hold it firmly in one hand; with the other, pick up the adapter and push it firmly down into the bottle neck.

Do not remove the adapter after inserting it.

Questions about anything in your parcel? Contact PCA before your first dose.

1300 070 910
info@painclinicaustralia.com.au

Ongoing usage

Six steps, every dose.

- 1 Open the lid on the bottle and insert the tip of the syringe into the opening in the adapter.
- 2 Make sure the syringe is firmly inserted within the adapter, then carefully turn the bottle upside down.
- 3 Using the syringe, slowly withdraw the correct dose from the bottle, keeping the tip of the syringe firmly in the adapter.
- 4 Once the correct dose is drawn, return both bottle and syringe to an upright position before carefully removing the syringe. Return any excess dose to the bottle using the syringe and adapter.
- 5 Add the dose underneath the tip of your tongue. You may add it to food or drink instead — if you do, make sure it is not too hot.
- 6 Close the lid over the adapter and bottle by turning it clockwise until tightened.

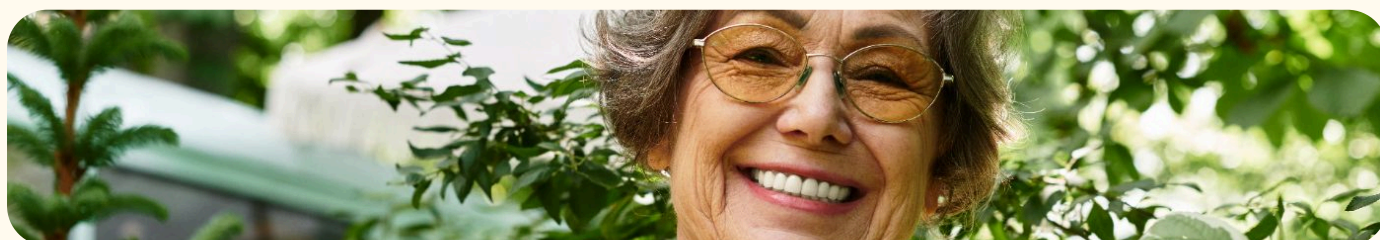
Cleaning the syringe

Rinse the barrel and plunger carefully with warm water and let them air dry. Keep them together in the same place so they aren't misplaced.

Storing your medication

Store upright in a cool, dark, dry place below 25°C. Refrigeration is not recommended — it thickens the oil and makes it hard to draw up.

As with any medication you ingest, there are risks as well as benefits. If you experience negative effects, contact your doctor or call the poisons hotline on **13 11 26**.



We're with you every step of the way

Our multidisciplinary treatment is designed for you to achieve the best outcome possible. If you have any questions about the use of your medicinal cannabis, or your treatment in general, please contact us.

HEAD OFFICE

1300 070 910

EMAIL

info@painclinicaustralia.com.au

POISONS HOTLINE

13 11 26

ONLINE

painclinicaustralia.com.au

